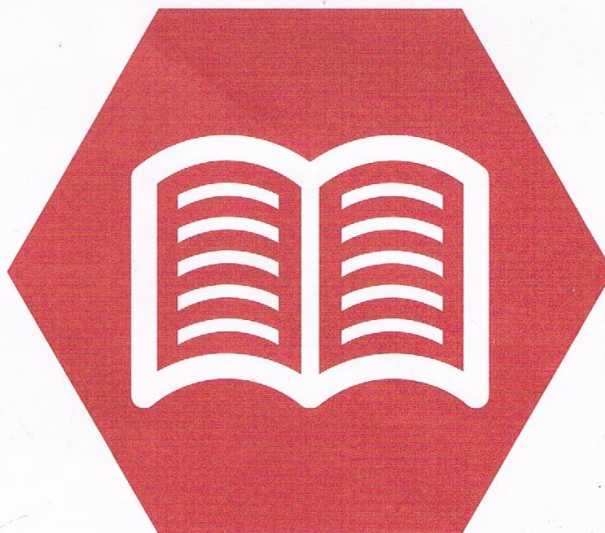




UNSW Global
THE UNIVERSITY OF NEW SOUTH WALES
SYDNEY • AUSTRALIA

INTRODUCTORY PAPER



2014 ICAS

International Competitions
and Assessments for Schools

ENGLISH

Educational Assessment Australia
eaa.unsw.edu.au

DO NOT OPEN THIS BOOKLET UNTIL INSTRUCTED.

35 QUESTIONS

TIME ALLOWED: 35 MINUTES

STUDENT'S NAME:

Read the instructions on the **ANSWER SHEET** and fill in your **NAME, SCHOOL** and **OTHER INFORMATION**.

Use a 2B or B pencil.

Do **NOT** use a pen.

Rub out any mistakes completely.

You **MUST** record your answers on the **ANSWER SHEET**.

Mark only **ONE** answer for each question.

Your score will be the number of correct answers.

Marks are **NOT** deducted for incorrect answers.

There are **35 MULTIPLE-CHOICE QUESTIONS** (1–35).

Use the information provided to choose the **BEST** answer from the four possible options.

On your **ANSWER SHEET** fill in the oval that matches your answer.

Questions may sometimes be placed next to each other.

Make sure you read **ACROSS** the page and answer the questions in the correct order.

You are **NOT** allowed to use a dictionary or an electronic translator.

Read *Vegetables* and answer questions 1 to 3.

VEGETABLES

These are vegetables that grow under the ground.



green radish



taro



yam bean

These are vegetables that grow above the ground.



kale



bok choy

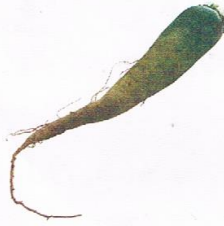


broccolini

1. Which picture shows a yam bean?



(A)



(B)



(C)



(D)

2. Which of these vegetables grows above the ground?

- (A) green radish
- (B) taro
- (C) yam bean
- (D) bok choy

3. This is a picture of a sweet potato.

It looks most like

- (A) the yam bean.
- (B) the green radish.
- (C) the broccolini.
- (D) the kale.



Fruit to eat



Monday, 14th August

On Friday, Mrs Evans said we should try to eat one piece of fruit at lunchtime every day. So today we all brought some fruit to school. I had juicy watermelon. Bob had a banana which had brown spots. Anna had some old strawberries. Sam had a squishy tomato and Jess had a pear that was covered in bruises. I think I had the best fruit by far!

By Jay



4. Which fruit did Anna bring?

- (A) pear
- (B) banana
- (C) watermelon
- (D) strawberries

5. Who had a tomato to eat?

- (A) Jay
- (B) Bob
- (C) Sam
- (D) Jess

6. What does the word 'squishy' mean?

- (A) smelly
- (B) chewy
- (C) soft
- (D) red

7. Which quotation shows Jay's opinion?

- (A) 'Mrs Evans said we should try to eat one piece of fruit'
- (B) 'we all brought some fruit to school'
- (C) 'a banana which had brown spots'
- (D) 'I think I had the best fruit by far!'



For questions 8 and 9 choose the sentence which is PUNCTUATED CORRECTLY.

8. (A) I like red cars, green cars and blue, cars.
(B) I like red cars, green cars and blue cars.
(C) I like, red cars, green cars, and blue cars.
(D) I like, red cars green cars and blue cars.
9. (A) I have'nt eaten my dinner yet.
(B) I have'not eaten my dinner yet.
(C) I haven't eaten my dinner yet.
(D) I hav'nt eaten my dinner yet.

Read *The Apple Tree* and answer questions 10 to 14.



The Apple Tree

Mr Brown had a magnificent apple tree. On this hung five ripe, red apples. Each day, Mr Brown went out to count the apples. 1, 2, 3, 4, 5! Five ripe, red apples.

One night, a tiny, grey mouse ran up the trunk of the tree. *Tip, tap! Tip, tap!* She chewed through the stem of one apple.

Plop!

It fell to the ground where the mouse family was waiting. *Nibble, nibble, nibble.* The mouse family soon ate up every piece of the apple then scampered back home.

The next morning, Mr Brown came out of his house and counted the apples.

1, 2, 3, 4! Only four apples!

'A tall, tall thief must have come in the night and stolen my apple,' he said. He went back into his house, very puzzled.

10. At the start of this story, how many apples were on the tree?
- (A) two
 - (B) three
 - (C) four
 - (D) five
11. Which word is used to describe the apple landing?
- (A) 'Tip'
 - (B) 'tap'
 - (C) 'Plop'
 - (D) 'nibble'
12. What is Mr Brown doing in the first picture?
- (A) counting the apples
 - (B) talking to the mouse
 - (C) climbing the apple tree
 - (D) watering his garden
13. At the end of the story, Mr Brown was puzzled because
- (A) he thought he had not counted the apples correctly.
 - (B) he wondered why the thief had not taken all the apples.
 - (C) he could not find the mouse family.
 - (D) he was not sure how the apple had been taken.
14. Mr Brown thought that the thief
- (A) was a mouse.
 - (B) was very tall.
 - (C) ran up the tree.
 - (D) waited for the apple to drop.



Read *Lola* and answer questions 15 to 21.

LOLA

I usually love waking up on a Saturday morning. On a school day it seems to take forever to find my uniform, get washed, dressed and downstairs for breakfast. But on Saturdays I can get from my bed to my breakfast in exactly fifty-three seconds! I know I can do it because I've timed it.

But today I feel a bit weird. It's like I'm in slow motion and my head feels too heavy to lift off the pillow. I can hear Mum downstairs and she sounds so cheery, like she's been up for hours. When I look at my clock, I realise why. It's 9 o'clock! She *has* been up for hours. I've wasted half of Saturday!

There is a plan for today, I'm sure. It starts with soccer. Then home for lunch before Tommy's party. I've been looking forward to it for ages. Mum has bought Tommy the best present ever. It's a science kit that shows you how to make a real rocket. He's going to love it and I know he'll ask me to help him build it. Yet, I can't seem to get out of bed.

The phone rings downstairs. I'd usually run and answer it but I feel exhausted even thinking about standing up. When Mum taps on my door a minute later, it's with bad news. Tommy's party is cancelled.

Sitting on my bed, she feels my head and then unbuttons my pyjama top to look at my super-spotty tummy. Tommy has chickenpox. And so do I!



15. Which quotation from the first paragraph tells readers that something different is going to happen to Lola?
- (A) 'I usually love waking up on a Saturday morning.'
 - (B) 'On a school day it seems to take forever to find my uniform'
 - (C) 'I can get from my bed to my breakfast in exactly fifty-three seconds!'
 - (D) 'I know I can do it'
16. Why did Lola say that she had 'wasted half of Saturday'?
- (A) She was feeling unwell.
 - (B) Her mother had forgotten to wake her up.
 - (C) She had slept in later than usual.
 - (D) Her alarm clock had not rung.
17. What do the words 'looking forward to' mean?
- (A) planning for
 - (B) ready for
 - (C) promising to go to
 - (D) excited about
18. 'Mum has bought Tommy the best present ever.'
- What is the effect of the word 'ever'?
- (A) It simplifies what happened.
 - (B) It exaggerates the statement.
 - (C) It shows Lola's determination.
 - (D) It shows that the information is important.
19. Which quotation is about something that happened in Lola's past?
- (A) 'I've timed it'
 - (B) 'It's a science kit'
 - (C) 'Yet, I can't seem to get out of bed.'
 - (D) 'The phone rings downstairs.'
20. Why was Tommy's party cancelled?
- (A) He woke up late.
 - (B) Lola could not go to the party.
 - (C) Lola had chickenpox.
 - (D) He had chickenpox.
21. What is Lola most likely to do next?
- (A) She will run down for breakfast.
 - (B) She will make the rocket.
 - (C) She will go to soccer.
 - (D) She will rest.



Read *What the nose knows* and answer 22 to 28.

What the NOSE KNOWS

Have you ever noticed how a smell or odour can sometimes cause you to remember something that happened in the past or perhaps make you think about someone? You smell lavender and think of visiting your grandmother's house. For me, the smell of mouldy fruit, especially oranges, reminds me of how I hid my uneaten fruit from my school lunch in my mother's sunhat on the top of the wardrobe! Or, more especially, I remember what happened whenever she used her sunhat. Why does smelling something help with recalling a memory?

First let's have a look at how we smell. Some things have a strong smell, which actually means the objects release tiny particles (molecules) into the air that special sensors in your nose can detect: think of onions or fresh bread, for example. Some things don't release many particles at all—a piece of steel, for example. The special sensors in your nose, called chemoreceptors, pass on information to the brain about a smell using electrochemical impulses.

Your brain has a store of 'smell memories' and can recognise something that you have smelled before. It matches a smell with a smell memory and in less than the blink of an eye, you have recognised a smell. Sometimes the brain throws in some extra information so that you not only recognise a smell but are also reminded of another time when you smelled the same thing (the mouldy fruit in my mother's sunhat, in my example!).

22. Apart from describing the topic, why else has the writer chosen this title?
- (A) to pose an important question
 - (B) to make it funny by playing with words
 - (C) to show that the answer is common knowledge
 - (D) to show that the words rhyme
23. The writer suggests that smelling lavender might remind readers of
- (A) their grandmother's house.
 - (B) a summer holiday.
 - (C) their bedroom.
 - (D) the beach.
24. What are 'chemoreceptors'?
- (A) electrical impulses
 - (B) information in the brain
 - (C) special sensors in your nose
 - (D) particles released by objects
25. 'It matches a smell'
- What does 'It' refer to?
- (A) store (B) brain (C) nose (D) smell
26. Here are four things that happen when we smell something.
1. chemoreceptors detect molecules
 2. object releases molecules
 3. brain receives information
 4. electrochemical impulses pass information about molecules
- What is the correct order?
- (A) 1, 2, 3, 4 (B) 2, 1, 4, 3 (C) 2, 3, 1, 4 (D) 4, 1, 3, 2
27. How do people recognise a smell?
- (A) The brain links a smell with a smell memory.
 - (B) The nose links a smell with previous smells.
 - (C) The nose remembers a smell.
 - (D) The brain links the molecules to the smell.
28. What type of text is *What the nose knows*?
- (A) narrative
 - (B) recount
 - (C) argument
 - (D) explanation

Listen and Learn

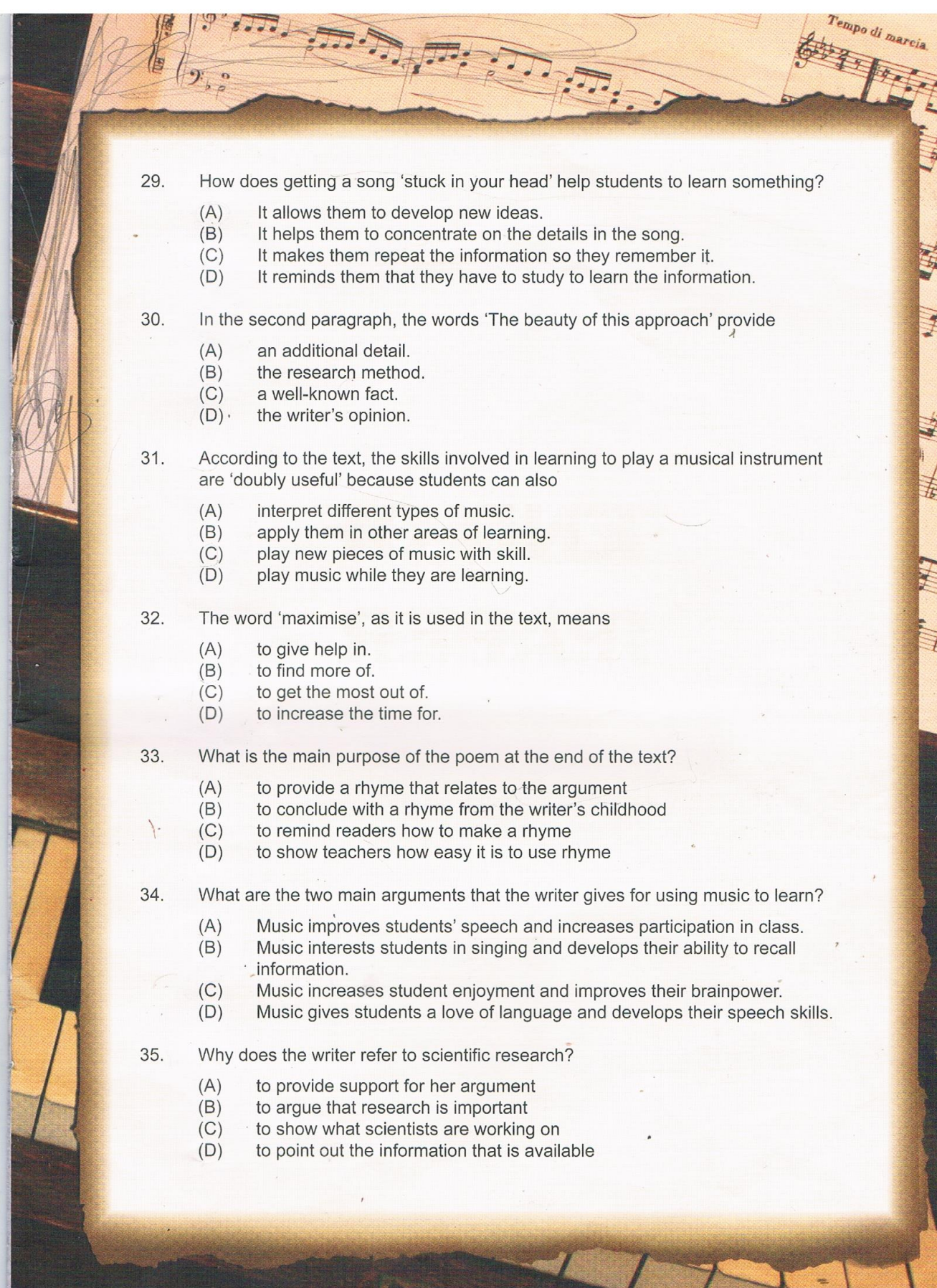
More time should be devoted to using music in the classroom to help learning. Scientists argue that learning songs and musical instruments can actually assist the learning of language and mathematics. In other words, Beethoven's back in a big way and Mozart's moving mountains in our minds—mountains of information, that is!

So, how can music help students to learn? Have you ever had a song in your head that just won't go away? Scientists have found that getting a song 'stuck in your head' can actually help you to learn new words and ideas. It seems repetition is the key to helping new information to 'stick'. This idea of words that just won't go away can be used in the classroom to support memorising and learning of new information. Research showed that when teachers used song and rhyme in the classroom, students more easily remembered new vocabulary and made use of new knowledge (the times tables, for example). Students are also more likely to remember information if it is learnt to a tune than if they only read it or hear it spoken. For example, *I need to hang the washing on the line and seven times seven equals forty-nine*. The beauty of this approach is that it is portable. It's 'anywhere anytime' learning.

Scientists have also found that playing an instrument assists learning. In 2011, researchers from the University of Ulm in Germany conducted research on musical ability and the brain. Their study showed that learning to play an instrument, like the piano or guitar, meant that students had to pay attention to detail. They also developed strong memories as a result of learning music pieces by heart. These skills are doubly useful because they are perfect preparation for training the brain to learn and memorise non-musical information. In fact, other scientists have found that students who study music tend to score well in mathematics.

It is clear that more time should be devoted to using music to maximise learning in schools. The use of music helps students to understand and remember new words and ideas easily. Of course, music makes students feel good and everyone knows that happy learners learn more. But the discoveries being made about the brain and how music can help students learn have given a whole new meaning to ideas about learning.

*Listen to the rhyme and keep to time,
Tap out the beat—you can use your feet.
It's never too late to reiterate,
Listen to the music and learn, learn, learn.*

- 
29. How does getting a song 'stuck in your head' help students to learn something?
- (A) It allows them to develop new ideas.
 - (B) It helps them to concentrate on the details in the song.
 - (C) It makes them repeat the information so they remember it.
 - (D) It reminds them that they have to study to learn the information.
30. In the second paragraph, the words 'The beauty of this approach' provide
- (A) an additional detail.
 - (B) the research method.
 - (C) a well-known fact.
 - (D) the writer's opinion.
31. According to the text, the skills involved in learning to play a musical instrument are 'doubly useful' because students can also
- (A) interpret different types of music.
 - (B) apply them in other areas of learning.
 - (C) play new pieces of music with skill.
 - (D) play music while they are learning.
32. The word 'maximise', as it is used in the text, means
- (A) to give help in.
 - (B) to find more of.
 - (C) to get the most out of.
 - (D) to increase the time for.
33. What is the main purpose of the poem at the end of the text?
- (A) to provide a rhyme that relates to the argument
 - (B) to conclude with a rhyme from the writer's childhood
 - (C) to remind readers how to make a rhyme
 - (D) to show teachers how easy it is to use rhyme
34. What are the two main arguments that the writer gives for using music to learn?
- (A) Music improves students' speech and increases participation in class.
 - (B) Music interests students in singing and develops their ability to recall information.
 - (C) Music increases student enjoyment and improves their brainpower.
 - (D) Music gives students a love of language and develops their speech skills.
35. Why does the writer refer to scientific research?
- (A) to provide support for her argument
 - (B) to argue that research is important
 - (C) to show what scientists are working on
 - (D) to point out the information that is available

**END OF
PAPER**